

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



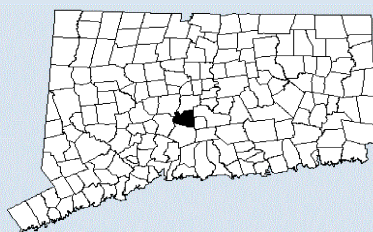
Meriden School District

Mark Benigni, Superintendent • 203-630-4171 • <http://www.meridenk12.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	31
Enrollment	8,789
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,794
Total Expenditures ¹	\$150,575,675

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	4,224	48.1	48.3
Male	4,539	51.6	51.5
Non-Binary	26	0.3	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	149	1.7	5.2
Black or African American	1,012	11.5	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,434	61.8	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	443	5.0	4.7
White	1,736	19.8	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,643	18.7	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,873	78.2	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	1,882	21.4	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	384	8.6
Male	1,075	24.2	564	11.6
Non-Binary	*	*	0	0.0
Black or African American	243	24.5	177	16.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,423	26.6	592	10.2
White	309	18.3	127	7.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	397	22.5	138	7.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,843	27.2	840	11.5
Students with Disabilities	618	35.4	350	16.0
District	2,094	24.2	948	10.2
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 3,857

Number of school-based arrests: 13

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	482.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	42.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	102.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	167.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.8
School Level	41.9
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	34.7
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	55.6
School Nurses	14.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	562.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.3	0.1
Asian	4	0.5	1.4
Black or African American	24	3.3	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	62	8.4	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	5	0.7	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	641	86.9	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.6	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	73	90.1	93	100.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	358	94.2	355	98.1
White	132	97.1	157	98.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	61	80.3	85	93.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	462	95.3	495	98.8
Students with Disabilities	105	93.8	178	98.9
District	606	94.2	649	98.5
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	129	46.9
Emotional Disability	73	39.2
Intellectual Disability	28	26.4
Learning Disability	477	79.5
Other Health Impairment	202	63.5
Other Disabilities	15	23.4
Speech/Language Impairment	104	95.4
District	1,028	62.0
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	340	3.8	2.6
Emotional Disability	187	2.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	109	1.2	0.6
Learning Disability	600	6.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	319	3.6	3.5
Other Disabilities	168	1.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	134	1.5	2.0
All Disabilities	1,857	20.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	66	3.6	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	58	3.1	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$95,629,986	\$10,666	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$11,458,672	\$1,335	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$789,926	\$92	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,835,271	\$214	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$6,910,983	\$805	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$5,823,023	\$678	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$19,138,256	\$2,230	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$7,206,627	\$1,416	\$1,582
Food services	\$371,602	\$43	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,411,330	\$164	\$213
Total	\$150,575,675	\$16,794	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,508,355	20.5	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,101,063	8.5	10.2
Other Salaries	\$6,463,325	17.6	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$4,602,774	12.6	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,457,614	4.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$9,215,367	25.1	22.2
Supplies	\$425,529	1.2	0.7
Property Services	\$172,311	0.5	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,699,077	10.1	8.4
Equipment	\$25,784	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$1,392	0.0	0.1
Total	\$36,672,590	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.4	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	33.0
State	51.9
Federal	14.3
Tuition & Other	0.8

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	74	70.8	74	69.8	*	*
Black or African American	501	59.2	500	51.5	193	50.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,742	58.9	2,720	54.9	1,194	53.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	229	65.0	226	60.0	84	61.5
White	891	70.8	886	65.5	386	64.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,023	52.8	1,015	53.1	398	50.3
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	3,420	64.5	3,397	58.3	1,496	57.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,536	59.8	3,508	54.9	1,501	54.4
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	907	69.6	904	65.7	393	62.2
Students with Disabilities	824	43.7	812	38.4	317	40.7
Students without Disabilities	3,619	65.9	3,600	61.3	1,577	59.1
High Needs	3,762	59.0	3,733	54.6	1,587	53.8
Non-High Needs	681	76.9	679	70.7	307	67.1
District	4,443	61.8	4,412	57.1	1,894	56.0

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	94.1	87.7	85.0	76.1	2,681	85.5
Curl Up	91.3	90.7	90.2	86.2	2,665	89.5
Push Up	82.4	68.3	66.6	61.5	2,641	69.4
Mile Run/PACER	84.9	60.2	41.4	46.1	2,657	57.7
All Tests - District	74.6	48.9	36.3	34.0	2,610	47.9
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	84	85.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	366	79.2
White	160	83.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	97	72.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	506	80.4
Students with Disabilities	134	56.0
District	648	81.9
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	228	36.3
Male	172	25.6
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	38	21.8
Hispanic or Latino	188	25.3
White	133	44.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	21	12.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	264	26.8
Students with Disabilities	10	3.4
District	400	30.7
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	66.8	75.7
Male	50.2	72.8
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	60.5	79.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	51.0	67.2
White	69.7	85.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	35.4	47.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	52.1	68.3
Students with Disabilities	36.6	50.0
District	58.4	74.4
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	61.8	75	41.2	50	82.4	63.9
	High Needs Students	59.0	75	39.4	50	78.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	57.1	75	38.1	50	76.1	60.2
	High Needs Students	54.6	75	36.4	50	72.8	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	56.0	75	37.3	50	74.7	61.8
	High Needs Students	53.8	75	35.9	50	71.8	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	59.9%	100%	59.9	100	59.9	58.7%
	High Needs Students	57.8%	100%	57.8	100	57.8	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	60.2%	100%	60.2	100	60.2	61.4%
	High Needs Students	59.5%	100%	59.5	100	59.5	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	54.3%	100%	27.1	50	54.3	58.9%
	Oral	49.7%	100%	24.9	50	49.7	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	24.2%	<=5%	11.6	50	23.3	17.7%
	High Needs Students	26.6%	<=5%	6.7	50	13.5	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	96.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	30.7%	75%	20.5	50	41.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		84.3%	94%	44.9	50	89.7	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		81.9%	94%	87.2	100	87.2	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		87.6%	94%	93.2	100	93.2	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		58.4%	75%	77.9	100	77.9	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.4% 47.9%	75%	31.9	50	63.9	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		58.0%	60%	48.3	50	96.7	55.0%
Accountability Index				989.8	1450	68.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.0	16.0	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	70.7	54.6	16.1	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	67.1	53.8	13.3	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	87.6%	6.4%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	97.5
Math	All Students	97.2
	High Needs Students	96.8
Science	All Students	96.2
	High Needs Students	95.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 47.5

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Meriden School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Meriden Public Schools (MPS) has eight elementary schools, three middle schools, and two high schools. More than 77% of the district's student population of 8,800 students are eligible for free or reduced-priced meals, and 75% are students of color. Implementing our District Improvement Plan has promoted student-centered learning environments across the district using blended learning, leading to greater choice and voice, critical thinking, creativity, and academic gains. Restorative practices at secondary schools have increased student voice. Elementary schools are also engaged in implementing restorative practices. In our 1:1 environment, students are provided district-issued devices to use with digital content in classes.

School improvement plans include assessments conducted regularly throughout the school year. School-based data teams analyze data to identify areas where improvement is needed and areas where significant progress has been made. While School Improvement Plans are specific to school needs, they are aligned to the District Improvement Plan's goals in Talent, Academics, Climate, and Operations.

With the adoption of Connecticut's Common Core Standards, the district has embedded these standards into the district's English Language Arts-Literacy and Mathematics curriculum and implemented the NGSS in Science and the Connecticut Elementary and Secondary Social Studies Frameworks. The District Improvement Plan was recently revised by the District Leadership Team which meets monthly to review district academic, attendance, discipline, and school climate data. The Team monitors progress, provides feedback, and makes recommendations to our central office team.

With grant funding from a foundation, Meriden has developed a visual Portrait of a Graduate which was created through an Advisory Committee which includes community members, parents, students, administrators, and teachers. The Portrait consists of five attributes: I am a Learner, I am a Thinker, I am an Advocate, I am a Collaborator, I am Prepared for life after high school. Each attribute has corresponding indicators. Currently school based teams at the high schools are constructing multiple learning experiences - in school and in the community-that will allow all students to develop these competencies and ensure access to those opportunities is equitable and available to all students.

Efforts to engage our families include our Family School Liaison Team, which works to connect families to school supports, educates families on school and district expectations, makes home visits, and fosters school-community events. Community and Parent Learning. The district recently implemented ParentSquare district-wide. ParentSquare enables users to select from 100 languages to receive messages, allows teachers to use it for class-group messaging and one-to-one communication, and allows permission slips, automatic attendance, and more. MPS has a 99.1% contact ability across the district.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Meriden Public Schools believes that education is the great equalizer and provides a path to a better life for all students. The district continues to be proactive in combating systemic racism in our schools. We embrace the richness of our diversity, value our tapestry of different colors and cultures, and remain committed to addressing racial discrimination or unconscious bias. Meriden ensures all students have access to quality educational experiences and graduate college, career and life ready. Our long-standing commitment to equity is evident in initiatives implemented during the last decade. We have generated a series of Racial Equity Awareness training modules, created an Affinity Group for educators of color and other interested teachers. Most importantly, the district has recently hired a Director of Equity and Instruction to ensure equitable opportunities and access for all learners.

Our steps include a six-pronged approach: 1). Equity Leaders are continuing to roll out racial equity awareness training modules to high school teachers in small group settings to encourage conversations about the material presented; 2). Equity Leaders are expanding racial equity awareness training to middle and high school teachers using the same protocols; 3) Equity Leaders are presenting components of racial equity awareness training modules at our Board of Education meetings, Administrators' Meetings, Elementary and Secondary Principals' Meetings, and Administrators' Retreat; 4) office of Personnel and Talent Development continues to pursue recruitment and hiring of teachers of color in collaboration with Affinity Group; 5) The Office of Research and Evaluation continues to provide central office and board of education with Student Climate Survey data and trend analyses of student perception of racism in their school and community as well as disciplinary data disaggregated by students of color; and 6) A District Sub-Committee was established to ensure the advancement of equitable learning opportunities throughout the district. Under the leadership of the Director of Equity and Inclusion, Meriden's High School Equity Leaders are training two Equity Leaders in each of our eight elementary schools and three middle schools.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Meriden Board of Education takes great care to equitably allocate resources among the district's schools and programs based on the needs of individual buildings and district initiatives and to apply an equity lens to allocations. Resources for such areas as ongoing supplies and compensation for the errors inherent in enrollment projections are maintained. The Office of Teaching and Innovation maintains an emergency account that ensures all schools have necessary materials in cases where the building budget is unable to meet needs. The size of the building determines resource allocations for custodial supplies and manpower, and the age and condition of buildings are used to determine the priority list for major improvements and repairs.